

4.4 Your Autobiography In Photos

Here's a special project you can start: a pictorial autobiography. Once you get a digital camera, making a biography of your life is practically effortless. The biggest drawback of owning a film camera is that you have to get the pictures scanned. The good thing about the digital medium is that you can turn your biography into a screensaver, a video CD or an Adobe Acrobat PDF document for easy distribution (refer to Section 3.1). Here are a few ideas you can use on this project:

- **Start with a family tree:** You can start your autobiography with a family tree, starting from pictures of your grandparents all the way down to your grandchildren (as and when they come along). You can make the tree as comprehensive as you like: after all, it's your family genealogy!
- **Open with baby shots:** If you had shutterbugs for parents, you are likely to have a few thousand photographs of you as a kid. If not, track the few pictures of you as a child that exist and use them to start your album. You can even start with your parents for added effect. Remember, if you or your parents do not have pictures of yourself as a kid, try contacting your friends or their parents—chances are there is a picture of you in a group photo at your friend's third birthday party!
- **Avoid clutter:** It's best to keep an autobiography brief! No one wants to see a day-by-day pictorial narration of your life. Keep it simple and clean so that people will remember it.

With a digital pictorial autobiography, you can update and change content to keep people interested. Add some humour in your captions that will make your family members say, "Awww! So sweet!"

**TIP**

Even the simplest object takes on new fascination in macro mode. Just look for the close up or macro mode icon, which is usually a flower symbol, turn it on, and get as close to an object as your camera will allow. Hold the shutter button down halfway to allow the camera to focus. When the confirmation light gives you the go ahead, press the shutter down the rest of the way. Keep in mind that you now have very shallow depth of field, so focus on the part of the subject that's most important to you—and let the rest of the image go soft.